

JAMES PAPOUTSIS

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PROFILE

Final year Bachelor of Accounting Science student at the University of the Witwatersrand, on a full Moore Johannesburg bursary with a signed training contract for SAICA articles from 2028. Four years of tutoring experience, three years of direct exposure to the audit profession through Moore's leadership programmes, and treasurer of a university rowing club accountable for more than R1 million in club funds across a season. Most at home where accounting meets technology, and inclined to build the tool I need rather than wait for one to exist.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Accounting Science

University of the Witwatersrand | 2024 to 2026

- Expected completion of the undergraduate degree at the end of 2026.
- Postgraduate Diploma in Accounting (CTA) to follow in 2027, with SAICA articles at Moore Johannesburg from 2028 to 2030.
- Current modules: Taxation III, Auditing III, Financial Accounting III, Managerial Accounting and Finance III.

National Senior Certificate

Edenglen High School | 2018 to 2023

- Subjects: Accounting, Computer Applications Technology, English, Life Orientation, Mathematics, Physical Sciences.
- Matriculated with six distinctions and the highest average in the matric class of 2023.
- Awarded Academic Full Colours and served as Head Boy.
- Trophies for Best Accounting Student and Best Mathematics Student, the Principal's Award and the Academic Gold Medal.

LEADERSHIP AND GOVERNANCE

Treasurer

Wits University Boat Club | 10/2025 to present

- Accountable for the finances of a club of more than 40 athletes, handling in excess of R1 million in club funds across the current season.
- Reconcile four concurrent payment streams, covering the winter training camp, squad kit, USSA entries and racing suits, across individual athlete accounts.
- Prepare budgets, set and collect athlete contributions, and follow up outstanding balances directly with athletes and their families.
- Run procurement through Wits Sport from quotation to order, covering ergometers, sweep oars, accessories and boat repairs.
- Produce official committee minutes and maintain the action items schedule arising from them.
- Organise fundraising, including a club quiz night, and manage the catering brief and full reconciliation for the winter training camp.
- Continuing in the role through 2027.

Treasurer

USSA Rowing Executive Committee | 2027 to 2030

- Elected to the national executive committee for university rowing in South Africa as Treasurer, for a term of three years beginning in 2027.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Scholarship Leadership Programmes

Moore Johannesburg | 07/2024, 07/2025 and 07/2026

Three consecutive years on the firm's leadership programme for bursary students.

- July 2026: completed a five day simulated audit of a fictional client in a team of bursary students, working from client acceptance and planning through to a Report to Management presented at the end of the week. Deliverables included planning documents, an audit planning memorandum, a client acceptance workbook and banking working papers.
- July 2025: programme centred on the firm itself, covering how Moore is structured, professional development inside it, and what the first years of articles actually involve.
- July 2024: programme centred on personal foundations, covering personality profiling, negotiation, communication and self development, with sessions run by the directors.
- Worked directly with audit managers, directors and partners across all three programmes.

Accounting Manager's Assistant

Altron, Woodmead | 07/2022 to 08/2022

- Invoice processing, account reconciliation, data entry for financial reports and assistance with financial statement preparation.

TUTORING EXPERIENCE

Tutor

TBT | 04/2026 to present

- Tutor four learners in Mathematics and Accounting, with structured written feedback prepared for parents after each lesson cycle.

Tutor

SOLV Tutors | 08/2025 to present

- Twelve learners to date and five currently, across Mathematics, Accounting and Physical Sciences for Grades 10 to 12.
- Prepare learners for examinations using IEB, CAPS and AS Level past papers, with an emphasis on answering technique and on repairing the foundational gaps underneath a weak mark.
- Build custom material where a learner needs it, including diagnostic papers, dependency ordered lesson plans, teaching booklets and practice tests.
- Manage scheduling, communicate with parents and submit monthly paydocs.

Private Tutor

Self employed, Bedfordview | 03/2024 to 07/2025

- Tutored three learners across several subjects and curricula, with lesson plans built around each learner rather than a fixed syllabus.

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Game Master and Administrative Assistant

Hashtag Escape, Bedfordview | 10/2024 to present

- Customer service, control panel operation, payment processing, bookings and administrative coordination.

Waiter

Bailey's Live, Bedfordview | 01/2024 to 10/2024

- Served a busy floor, managed point of sale operations, issued table checks, collected payments and resolved customer concerns.

Instructor

Go Ape, Modderfontein | 12/2022 to 10/2023

- Led outdoor adventure activities, held responsibility for participant safety, managed bookings and handled customer service.

PROJECTS

Ascent, a personal dashboard

2026, ongoing

- Designed and built a single user web application in Next.js on a Neon Postgres database, deployed on Vercel and installable as a progressive web app across phone, tablet and laptop.
- Work and invoicing module: hours captured per employer and per student, outstanding totals for three pay periods that align neither with each other nor with a calendar month, and invoice PDFs generated on demand.
- Marks module: weighted tracking across four modules including the separate final examination hurdle, with a progress report export.
- Focus module: a pomodoro timer that logs every session to the database and survives navigation and app closure, with streaks derived from the session log.
- Tasks module: deadline tracking fed one way from a Notion archive to preserve a single source of truth.

Litigation Tracker, for a South African law firm

2026

- Built a secure multi user case management web application to replace a single machine HTML tool, giving two attorneys in different locations a shared and current view of the firm's litigation caseload.
- Modelled three matter types with branching procedure in a single configuration file, so the firm's process can change without code changes, while each matter retains its own copy of its steps.
- Delivered an audit trail, digest email notifications with quiet hours, filtered PDF and CSV reporting, a private calendar feed for deadlines and a mobile friendly interface.
- Secured with invite only accounts, bcrypt password hashing, server side sessions for instant revocation, rate limited logins and security headers on every response.
- Built with Next.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL on Neon, Drizzle ORM and Vercel. Running as a live demo while the firm decides on hosting.

Taxation group project: VAT on a student accommodation development

2026

- Analysed the value added tax consequences of a student accommodation development in Parktown, applying the Supreme Court of Appeal decision in Respublica to facts that did not map onto it cleanly.
- Set out the characterisation of the supply, the input tax position and the practical exposure for the developer, presented as a group video submission.

Deloitte CA of the Future: AI in the shipping process

2024

- Developed a digital transformation strategy for a chocolate manufacturer, digitising the shipping and invoicing cycle using AI driven inventory management, automated invoicing and smart delivery tracking.

- Conducted a risk analysis covering cybersecurity, system failure and AI miscommunication against the triple bottom line, and applied IAS 2 to the costs of purchase and conversion.
- Submitted as a written report with a ten minute team presentation.

BDO project: the BioCane business model

2024

- Built a full business model for a bioplastic producer based in the Somkhele mining community in KwaZulu Natal, in a team of six with each member owning a business function.
- Responsible for financial planning including a five year budget, alongside SWOT and PESTLE analyses, risk management and alignment to the Sustainable Development Goals.

SKILLS

Accounting and audit: IFRS, Income Tax Act and VAT Act application, auditing standards, working paper preparation, reconciliation

Professional software: Caseware Working Papers, Power BI, Syft, Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Office Suite

Programming: Python, SQL, JavaScript. Prior exposure to C and C#

Web development: HTML, CSS, Next.js, React

Data and deployment: Postgres on Neon, Vercel, GitHub, Notion

Platforms: Windows, macOS, Linux

Teaching: CAPS, IEB and AS Level alignment, lesson planning, diagnostic assessment, past paper technique

Strengths: Financial stewardship, communication with clients and parents, leadership of a committee, time management across competing commitments, composure in fast paced environments

HONOURS AND AWARDS

Moore Johannesburg Bursary

10/2023

- Awarded a full bursary including a signed three year training contract to complete articles upon graduation, in recognition of academic potential and professional promise in chartered accountancy.

Edenglen High School Honours Blazer

10/2023

- The first Honours Blazer awarded in five years, for full colours across academics, leadership, service, sport and culture.

Edenglen High School Honorary Scholarship

2020 to 2023

- Awarded for Grades 9 to 12 in recognition of consistent excellence in academics, leadership, sport and cultural activities.

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Life Group Leader

Cornerstone Bedfordview | 2026

- Member of Cornerstone Bedfordview since 2025 and baptised in 2026. Lead a young adults life group, holding responsibility for preparation, facilitation and pastoral follow up.

Head of Recycling

Edenglen High School | 11/2022 to 11/2023

- Initiated and managed a school wide recycling project, overseeing three recycling sheds and coordinating roughly 25 volunteers.

SPORT AND EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

Rowing: Wits University Boat Club. Raced at the USSA Boat Race in 2025 and 2026, USSA Sprints 2026 and VLC Sprints 2026, in the men's eight, the quad and the pair

Running: African Bank Soweto Marathon, 42.2 km, November 2025. First half marathon at the aQuellé Zone 3 Marathon, Emmarentia, September 2025

School: First Team Debating in the Gauteng competitions, First Team Chess as Captain, First Team Athletics and Cross Country, Public Speaking, Mathematics Olympiad, Swimming

Other: Wits Integrated Experience 2022

LANGUAGES

English: Native

Afrikaans: Intermediate reading and writing, basic speaking

REFERENCES

Available on request.